

## Google's news for you

Google is now going beyond just giving you all the search results in the world. A new feature in Google News lets you monitor a topic and receive e-mail alerts just as news reports on that topic break out. Still under beta testing, the Google News Alerts tool provides you daily notifications or bulletins as the news is reported.

A number of Web-based services such as Yahoo! and MSN have begun showing a keen interest in the search engine business and are gearing up for the big fight with Google. Yahoo! has already attempted to even out the competition by providing customised news alerts too.



## Stamp of Identity

Snail mail could soon be getting smarter, if recent research by the US Postal Service (USPS) is successfully implemented. According to its study, mail could be more efficiently tracked and delivered, if sender identification techniques are built into the postage systems of the future. The USPS is looking into creating personalised stamps that embed digital identification

information. It claims that not only will this enhance tracking,



## Microsoft: Copycat Monopoly?

A federal jury in the US ordered Microsoft to pay a sum of US\$ 520 million as damages to Chicago based Eolas (Embedded Objects Linked Across Systems) and the University of California. Eolas claimed that Microsoft used its system of placing small interactive content such as applets on Web pages with Internet Explorer that was bundled along with Windows. The University of California

holds the patent to the system while Eolas owns the technology rights.

The final damages figure was calculated to be US\$ 1.47 as royalty per unit for the 354 million copies of Windows, sold from November 1998 to September 2001. Microsoft said that the patent did not have any validity and that it would be filing an appeal against the verdict and the damages awarded.

but also ensure overall security of the mail system. However, civil liberty activists are quick to point out that this violates the right to privacy and free speech as it denies you the option of sending mail anonymously.

## redalert

### Backdoor.Sdbot.P

Backdoor.Sdbot.P—a variant of Backdoor.Sdbot—is a backdoor Trojan Horse that affects all Windows systems. The infected system allows unauthorised remote access. The Trojan infects the %System%\Mscedit32.exe file, modifies certain registry values and takes control of the IRC client in the infected PC, using which it downloads and executes files to launch DOS attacks on a target defined by the creator.

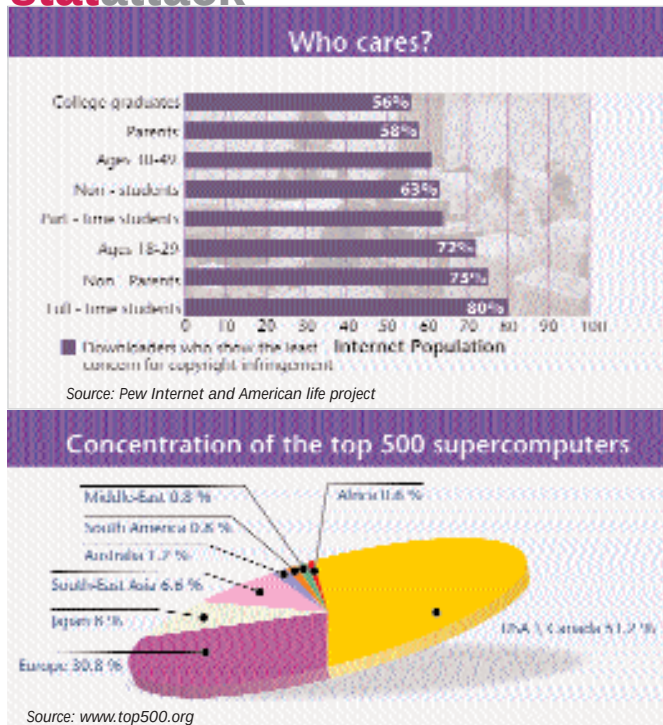
Remove the Trojan by disabling system restore and reverse the changes made to the registry. Also update the virus definition. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/backdoor.sdbot.p.html> for further details.

### W32.Sobig.F@mm

This is a mass mailing and network-aware worm that infects all Windows systems. It scans the host for files with extensions such as txt, wab, htm, etc., and sends a copy of itself to all the addresses it finds in these files. The worm uses its own SMTP engine to propagate and attempts to create a copy of itself on accessible network shares. It uses a fake sender address ([admin@internet.com](mailto:admin@internet.com)) when it propagates itself. Visit <http://securityresponse1.symantec.com/sarc/sarc.nsf/html/w32.sobig.f@mm.html> to download the removal tool.



## statattack



## Sony wades through gloomy waters

Sony PS2 sales dropped by almost 2 million as compared to last year. To remove the gloom, Sony is planning to provide a push for its next generation products—the PSP portable gaming console and the PSX home entertainment system. The PSP is Sony's answer to the Nintendo Game Boy Advance—the undisputed leader in the portable console gaming industry. The PSX is tipped to be an entertainment system integrated with a Playstation. Both appear to be quality products that could capture the market if appropriately priced.